

The first time

For many people, having sex for the first time is an exciting, strange, and nerve-wracking experience. Feeling relaxed and making sure that both partners are emotionally ready and physically aroused will help to make the experience a good one, but if one partner wants to stop at any point, the other must respect that decision.



△ Unrealistic portrayal

Unlike in films, having sex for the first time is sometimes a bit embarrassing and awkward.

GOOD TO KNOW

What to expect

- Sex might feel odd or uncomfortable at first, but it really shouldn't be painful.
- If it's painful for a young woman, it's most likely because she isn't fully aroused and the vagina isn't lubricated enough. This may be due to nerves or not enough foreplay.
- For females, bleeding during the first time is not the result of the hymen breaking, but instead due to a lack of vaginal lubrication and tears in the vaginal wall.
- Young men shouldn't feel anxious about sex lasting a long time or making their partner orgasm. It's normal for people not to orgasm the first time they have sex, and nerves may mean that it doesn't last for very long or that it is difficult to get, or to keep, an erection.
- Safer sex practices are essential to avoid sexually transmitted diseases (STDs) and pregnancy. It is possible to contract an STD or get pregnant the first time you have sex.

GOOD TO KNOW

Virginity and stigma

People who haven't had sex are sometimes portrayed in the media as naive or sexually repressed, while people who have had sex often are shown to be promiscuous or prone to taking risks. Additionally, old ideas and misconceptions still exist that suggest women are uninterested in sex or should remain chaste, while men are keen to have sex and should be sexually experienced.

All of these ideas can make women feel as if they shouldn't want or enjoy sex, and men feel embarrassed about being virgins.

Remember, feeling sexual and wanting to have sex is a natural part of growing up, but many people choose to wait to have sex until they are confident they feel ready. Losing your virginity should happen at a time and in a situation in which you feel comfortable, no matter what age you are.

Talking to others

It's natural to want to talk about a decision as big as having sex for the first time, or to want to ask someone else for advice before or after it happens. Some teens will want to tell everyone they know that they've had sex for the first time. Others may only want to tell someone they feel really close to.

▽ Confiding about sex

Talking about it can provide advice and support, but it's important to make clear that the conversation is private.

